



Scoreboard

PVR Software

	PVCR II ver 3.0	WinDVR	NeoTV	ChrisTV	WinVDR	iuVCR
Video Recording	MPEG 1/2, DV-to-MPEG	MPEG 1/2, VCD, DVD, DV-to-MPEG	MPEG 1/2, VCD, DVD	MPEG 1/2, AVI, DivX, XviD	MPEG 1/2, AVI, MP4, VCD, DVD, WMV, MOV	AVI, DivX, XviD
TV Image Snapshot						
BMP/JPEG	4/6	4/4	4/6	4/4	6/6	4/4
Live Pause/Replay	4	4	6	4	4	6
Multi-Channel Preview	4	4	6	4	6	6
Zoom Live TV	6	4	6	4	6	6
Timer Control						
For Recording	4	6	4	4	4	4
To Turn Off PVR	6	4	6	6	6	6
Scheduled Recording	4	4	6	4	6	4
Miscellaneous	Direct burn to DVD	Parental control, burn to disc	Configurable hotkey	Scheduler can be set according to the days of the week	NA	NA
Rating (Out Of 5)						
Ease Of Use	3.75	3.5	2.75	2.75	2.75	2.75
Live TV Preview	3.5	3.5	3	2.75	2.75	2.75
Video Capture	3.5	3.5	0	2.5	2.25	2.5
Snapshots	3	3	3	3	0	2.25
Features	3	3.75	2.25	3.5	2.5	2.5
Overall	67	69	44	58	41	51
Cost	\$49.95 (Rs 2,260)	\$79.95 (Rs 3,620)	\$30.00 (Rs 1,360)	\$49.95 (Rs 2,260)	\$39.00 (Rs 1,770)	\$26.95 (Rs 1,220)

Features And Performance

The first impression that WinVDR makes with respect to features is the list of video capture formats it supports: AVI, DIVX, MPEG, VCD,DVD, WMV, MP4, MOV... the list is never-ending!

WinVDR does include necessary features such as the time-limiter to control unattended video recording, and live TV pausing. Now, despite supporting so many video formats, there is no Snapshot feature. This is one of the many reasons that WinVDR lost out in this comparison test.

The other is the poor capture quality, with lots of pixel-grains, especially in the brighter sections of the captured clip. The preview is much better, though.

[Link: artech365.com/winvdr/index.htm](http://artech365.com/winvdr/index.htm)

Summing It Up

NeoTV and WinVDR lacked some features, and the video capture of the latter product was just about satisfactory. iuVCR had good features but lacked slightly on the quality front.

We decided that the winner had to be either PowerVCR or WinDVR. Since the highlight of the comparison was the features of the software, WinDVR leads the comparison table, along with ChrisTV. But ChrisTV did not offer the clarity we were looking for. The performance department—that is, the quality of image and video capture—belonged to PowerVCR and WinDVR.

It wasn't easy to choose between PowerVCR and WinDVR, but after much deliberation, we decided that WinDVR was the winner by a very small margin. ☒

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